

Human Factors and Security Practices

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Exercise 6.1: Analyzing Job Descriptions

IBM Associate Cyber Security Consultant in Toronto Job Posting

This job posting found on LinkedIn found for the IBM Associate Cyber Security Consultant job posting includes information about roles, responsibilities, technical experience, and professional experience of this position. The tools and frameworks mentioned are Q Radar, Splunk, Sentinel, NIST, PCI-DSS, IDS/IPS, SIEM, Python, and PowerShell. Attackers who understand the mentioned SIEM tools such as Q Radar, Splunk, and Sentinel that aggregate and analyze security logs and alerts can attempt to generate false positives and hide malicious activity. The roles mentioned are SOC, Threat Management, Identity and Access Management, and Consulting. Attackers can mimic IBM cybersecurity professionals, especially security operations center and consulting roles, to perform social engineering or phishing attacks.

Wayfair Cybersecurity Engineer Intern Job Posting

This job posting found on LinkedIn for the Wayfair Cyber Security Engineer Intern job posting includes information about roles, responsibilities, basic qualifications, and preferred qualifications about the position. Attackers can perform social engineering attempts or physical intrusion attempts during the three days in office mentioned in the work schedule, or phishing attacks during the two days during remote work in the same schedule.

Exercise 6.2: Assessing Background Checks

Sterling Background Checks

Sterling Backcheck is a Canadian company that is leading in the industry of background check services.

Investigative Service Offered

Sterling Backcheck offers criminal record checks, enhanced police information checks, and vulnerable sector checks. The RCMP and local police information provides access to the National Repository of Criminal Records for Sterling to use and perform backchecks. Sterling also verifies employment and education, international background checks, and credit bureau inquiries.

Information Provided to Employers

Employers are mainly provided information verified information about job candidates including employment history, education verification, and criminal record checks. Employment history can include previous jobs, dates of employment, and supporting documents of job duties. Verified education may include degrees, diplomas, or certifications from educational institutions. Lastly, criminal record checks confirm the presence of criminal records of the job candidate.

Data Protection and Sharing Methods

Sterling Backcheck uses advanced security measures including encryption of data in transit and at rest, firewalls, and continuous monitoring to protect against hackers and viruses and securely share the data. They ensure effectiveness of their security systems by performing audits and tests with internal and external parties. Access limited to authorized personnel and compliant service providers strictly

controls personal information. Sterling shares private information through secure channels only with clients, authorized parties, and service providers that can meet their standards for data protection.

Consent of the Individual

Sterling Backcheck requires consent from the person being checked before performing them as it complies with the Personal Information Protection and Electronic Documents Act (PIPEDA) of Canada. All background checks performed are not done in secret.

Exercise 6.3: Learning What Your Social Media Says About You

What Potential Employers or Hackers Can Learn About You

Potential employers look at your social media accounts, public posts, and work you have shared online to learn more about your accomplishments, experience, skills, personality, and cultural fit. Hackers can learn exploitable information from your social media including your full name, email address, phone number, and home address. Additionally, hackers can see your posts, likes, and interactions that can reveal personal preferences.

Personal Data That Can Be Exploited

Personal data that can be exploited from my social media account for phishing, identity theft, or password guessing attacks are personal identifiers, employment or education details, and patterns of activity. They can use this data to create highly believable phishing messages, guess passwords, and impersonate, and send malicious links in the posts or messages.

Summary

Digital footprints leave trails of data from online activities which forms your online identity which can create risks. Habits, preferences, connections, and behaviors can be revealed from footprints, often without full awareness. Employers especially use digital footprints to filter job candidates while cybercriminals exploit personal information.

Exercise 6.4: Evaluating the Actions of Bad Employees

Data Mishandling Case

The following is a real-world case in Canada where an employee was prosecuted for mishandling confidential information.

Situation

An employee from an Ontario cleaning services company was terminated and misused confidential client information. He downloaded sensitive data onto a hard drive from major clients the employee used to manage after his termination. He used the data to harass prior managers and clients which led to legal actions of interlocutory injunction and Anton Piller order.

Laws Violated

The Personal Information Protection and Electronic Documents Act (PIPEDA) was violated as personal information and confidential data was mishandled. PIPEDA regulated collection, use, and disclosure of personal information by private companies such as the one mentioned in this case.

Consequences

The employee tried to claim that he was acting as a “whistleblower” for clients, but the claim was rejected by the court. The court viewed his actions as a retaliation against the business reputation of the employee. The actions of the employee resulted in an interlocutory injunction and Anton Piller order, with costs of \$34,570 against the worker due to his campaign of harassment.

Methods of Prevention

The case could have been prevented using legal compliance, security measures, and employee education. The policies of the company should have covered acceptable use of company resources and post-employment restrictions on data. Employees should have been trained on maintaining confidentiality. Lastly, access controls should have been placed to limit data that is used for work purposes.

Exercise 6.5: Evaluation Security Awareness Training

Cybersecurity Awareness Training Program

CyberSapiens is a cybersecurity awareness training program in Canada.

Key Topics

Topics include security of passwords, emails, social engineering, internet usage, mobile devices, data protection, remote work, incident response, social media, insider threats, software updates, ransomware, cloud services, corporate policies, and compliance.

Effectiveness

CyberSapiens trained over 500,000 users from more than 300 sessions. Users are satisfied with the program and praise its organized curriculum. Participants reported enhanced skills and confidence in dealing with threats. Usage and positive feedback reflect that this training program increases cybersecurity awareness in Canadian context.

Awareness Program Recommendation Memo

I recommend adopting the CyberSapiens cybersecurity awareness training program for our college. This program is widely recognized in Canada, having trained over 500,000 users with an effective curriculum covering important topics such as phishing awareness, password security, incident response, and data protection. Delivered by experienced experts, the program combines theoretical knowledge with practical application, enhancing skills and confidence in recognizing and mitigating cyber threats. Implementing this training will help cybersecurity students in our college to reduce risks, improve compliance, and build a resilient cybersecurity culture among students and staff.

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